

7. Pimp My Console

Looking at the same design and graphics on your console day-in and day-out can get pretty tiresome. That's why we have case modding—you can change the colours and looks of your console. You could just take the correct paints and go berserk on your console, but if you're not the DIY type, there are several options to choose from off the Internet. High-quality, vinyl stickers can be stuck onto the console to change its colour and graphics. You get a wide range of stickers at www.decalgirl.com, and they also offer to "skin" your controller with the same design aesthetics!

On the other hand, if you want to completely change the design of your Xbox 360 or Wii, you can do so with the I-Case provided by MCX. The I-Case comes in myriad colours from chrome to semi-transparent blue, and has different case designs too!

The Good: Keeps the Xbox cool, provides bragging rights!

The Not-so-much: Voids warranty, nowhere to go if you get stuck while building it

Price: Varies depending on product

Available at: www.nyko.com, www.decalgirl.com



6. Yo-Yo Strap

We're glad someone took those funny images of Wii-motes embedded in TVs seriously enough to make the retractable Wii-mote Wrist Strap.

This contraption features a strong cord connected to a retractable device, embedded into a wrist strap, which connects to your Wii-mote. The retractable device will soon get loose, though, making it another plastic projectile that people around you in the room should watch out for!

The Good: The wrist strap looks cool

The Not-so-much: You don't want to be in the way when your Wiimote makes its return journey

Price: \$6 (Rs 250)

Available at: <http://tinyurl.com/2tfwsa>



5. Becoming Schumacher!

Over the years, racing games have evolved from those 8-bit one-race games to games with complex AI and near-realistic simulations of real-world scenarios. Racing games become even more realistic and fun to play when they are accompanied by a racing wheel and pedals.

The Ubisoft Thrustmaster for the Wii is just like any other Wii accessory—basic and functional. It comes bundled with *GT Pro* series and *4x4: World Circuit* racing games. The entire focus here seems to be on gameplay and ease of use—like all things Wii. The Ubisoft Thrustmaster steering wheel is made of foam, and has a slot in the middle for docking the Wiimote, so the buttons are easily accessible during gameplay.

The Good: Cheapest steering accessory among all console steering wheels

The Not-so-much: Looks like the manufacturers are taking the "low development cost" of the Wii a bit too seriously

Price: \$45 (Rs 1,900) **Available at:** <http://tinyurl.com/2sxd09>

Next in line is the Logitech GT Force FX steering wheel for the PS3, which is one stunning wheel. With features like a 250-degree turning radius and 12 mappable buttons on the wheel, it's disappointing to note there's no support for force feedback or the rumble effect. The rubber padding on the wheel comes in handy during those extreme manoeuvring moments. It also features accelerator and brake pedals.

The Good: Great looking design, good build, good turning radius **The Not-so-much:** No rumble, expensive **Price:** \$50 (Rs 2,050) **Available at:** Not yet available

The "wireless" tag on the Xbox 360 Wireless Steering Wheel is a bit of a misnomer—if you want to experience the force-feedback and rumble effects, the pedals have to be plugged in. The steering is completely wireless, though. Another amazing feature of the Xbox 360 Wireless Racing Wheel is the F1-like styled gear shift paddles, located just behind the steering wheel close to its shaft. This allows you to change gears without taking your hand off the steering wheel, and change camera angles on the fly. It also supports wireless headphones for.

The Good: (Mostly) Wireless

The Not-so-much: Just "mostly"

Price: \$130 (Rs 5,450) **Available at:** <http://tinyurl.com/n9wdz>

